

The AI Receptionist Tech-Stack Cheat Sheet

Free 1-pager — the exact stack to build a voice-AI phone receptionist

Give this away free (a \$0 Gumroad listing that collects email, or a simple opt-in). It builds your list and pre-sells the full kit. Footer links to the kit.

The whole machine on one page

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CALLER → [forwards business line] → VOICE AGENT → texts owner a summary
|
WEBSITE (demo # + checkout + chat) → PAYMENTS → ONBOARDING → DATABASE → you provision
```

The stack (and why each piece)

Layer	Tool	Why	Free to start?
Voice agent + phone #	Retell AI	API-first, provisions the number, low latency	Build free; pay per live minute
The "brain" (sales chat)	Claude API	Natural, controllable, honest	Pennies at this scale
Payments / subscription	Stripe	Recurring billing + the consent moment	Free; % per charge
Database	Supabase	Customers, transcripts, settings	Yes
Website	Next.js + Netlify/Vercel	Fast, free hosting	Yes
Automation (later)	n8n / Make	Form → agent → number → email	n8n self-host free
Cold email (later)	Instantly / Smartlead	Warmup + deliverability	Paid — not needed for customer #1

The 3 rules that matter most

1. **Don't automate a step until it's worked by hand 5 times.** First customer beats perfect system.
2. **The demo IS the close.** Build one great demo agent, put its number front and center, and tell skeptics: "call it, try to break it." It sells itself.
3. **Run it straight.** Inbound-only AI (no robocalls), CAN-SPAM email, recording disclosure, honest "I'm a virtual assistant" when asked. Compliant *and* it builds trust.

The minimum to make your first sale

One demo agent (Retell) + a way to take payment (a Stripe link) + a phone to cold-call leads from. That's it. Everything else is polish.

Pricing that works

\$300/mo flat. No setup fee. No contract. Cancel anytime. It only has to catch one missed job a month to pay for itself — and for a roofer or plumber, one job is four figures.

Want the whole system — the fill-in-the-blank prompts, the 5-email cold sequence, the objection library, the go-live runbook? → The AI Receptionist Launch Kit: [YOUR GUMROAD LINK]

No income claims. Just the real, working system — so you skip the three weeks of figuring it out.